

A new reign

Elizabeth settled into her dual roles as a wife and mother, but her father, the King, was very ill. Her life was about to change forever.

In 1951, the princess took the ailing King's place at the Trooping the Colour parade, riding on horseback. Though not yet at ease at formal events, she also hosted a dinner for the King of Norway (her great-uncle). Her father had planned to make a Commonwealth tour, but his doctors wanted it delayed. Elizabeth was



What is Trooping the Colour?

When guards march their regiment's flag ("color") past troops at the royal birthday parade in London.